

UMER ATIQ

Software Engineering Manager | Fintech & Digital Payments

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering manager with 6+ years of experience building and scaling digital banking and payment systems for banks and financial institutions in Pakistan and Ethiopia. Lead a 16-member engineering team across backend, frontend and DevOps, owning mobile and internet banking, back-office and the financial transaction switch (load-tested at 2,000 TPS) for **NBP, Bank of Punjab, CDNS, Cerisma, Halan and PPCBL**. NBP's mobile app serves **1.2–1.5 million customers**. Built four client platforms from scratch, including Bank of Punjab's, whose phase one went live in **one month**. Deep expertise in Java, Spring Boot, ISO 8583, ISO 20022, RAAST and State Bank of Pakistan (SBP) compliance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Engineering Leadership • Hiring & Performance Management • Sprint Planning & Estimation • Client & Stakeholder Management • Requirement Gathering • Solution Architecture • Microservices • Mobile & Digital Banking • Payment Switching • Instant Payments (RAAST, IPS) • Regulatory Compliance (SBP, PCI-DSS) • AI-Driven Test Automation • Production Incident Resolution

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Paysys Labs | Karachi, Pakistan

Sep 2020 – Present

Leading provider of digital banking, payment switching and middleware solutions for banks and financial institutions

Manager Software Engineering

Sep 2024 – Present

- Lead a **16-member engineering team** across backend, frontend and DevOps through 5 team leads, expanded from a 7-member backend team after promotion.
- Own hiring, interviews, performance reviews, sprint planning and effort estimation for the full team.
- Accountable for end-to-end delivery of the **Open Digital** platform (mobile apps, internet banking, backend and back-office) and the transaction switch for six banks and financial institutions.
- Built CDNS, Halan, Cerisma and Bank of Punjab **from scratch**. Bank of Punjab's phase one launched in **one month**.
- Subject matter expert for the transaction switch** and escalation point for critical switch issues across Paysys projects.
- Conduct **company-wide training sessions** on ISO 8583, Open Connect switch configuration, AI-driven test automation and using AI in day-to-day development.
- Act as primary technical contact for bank clients, leading requirement gathering, solution design and delivery planning.
- Design the frontend and backend architecture for every new sprint, write backend code alongside the team and guide frontend and mobile engineers.
- Introduced **AI-driven regression testing**: guided the team to build a tool that runs the mobile app, internet banking and back-office end to end and produces UAT evidence reports with test cases and screenshots, cutting report time from **1–2 days to 1–2 hours** per sprint across all Open Digital clients.
- Consistently meet delivery deadlines, enforce code quality through unit testing, static analysis and CI pipelines, and lead production issue resolution.

Senior Software Engineer / Team Lead

Jan 2023 – Aug 2024

- Led a **7-member backend team** building new client backends from scratch, owning design, coding and debugging.
- Mentored junior engineers and set development standards to deliver on time and within budget.
- Owned end-to-end backend delivery, from design and documentation to testing, working with QA and product.
- Led maintenance and upgrades of existing systems, making technology decisions to improve performance.

Software Engineer

Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

- Independently designed, developed and tested backend features for the transaction switch and national-level payment platforms.

Associate Software Engineer

Sep 2020 – Dec 2021

- Configured the Open Connect switch for client banks and contributed to early development of SBP's RAAST Connector.

iTechnologi Group | Karachi, Pakistan

Nov 2019 – Feb 2020

Associate Software Engineer

- Contributed to software design, development and testing, resolved defects and took part in Agile sprint ceremonies.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, SQL, JavaScript

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Spring, Spring Security, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, Thymeleaf

Payments & Standards: ISO 8583, ISO 20022, RAAST, IPS, IBFT, ATM/POS, 1LINK, NADRA Verisys, BVS/MBVS

Security: OAuth2, JWT, Keycloak, Encryption, PCI-DSS

Databases & Messaging: MS SQL Server, Oracle, MySQL, RabbitMQ, Redis, Memcached

Testing, CI & Tools: JUnit, Mockito, SonarQube, Postman, Swagger, GitLab CI, Git, GitHub, JIRA, Linux

Team Stack (technical guidance): React, React Native

AI Tools: Claude, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot

KEY PROJECTS

Open Digital – Mobile Banking, Internet Banking & Back-Office Platform

Oct 2020 – Present

Live: NBP (1.2–1.5M app customers), Bank of Punjab, CDNS, Cerisma, Halan | In development: PPCBL

Java, Spring Boot, Microservices, Spring Security, SQL Server, React, React Native

- **Architecture:** complete channel unit (mobile app, internet banking, back-office and Transaction Gateway) on a microservices backend built for high-volume processing, with every transaction routed through the Open Connect switch.
- **Onboarding & verification:** customer registration with NADRA Verisys and biometric verification (BVS and MBVS).
- **Payments:** IBFT, bill payments (NADRA, 1LINK) and card transactions. Led 1LINK certification of IBFT and bill payment services on ISO 8583.
- **RAAST (channel side):** RAAST ID registration, P2P transfers, QR payments and Request to Pay, integrated into the banks' mobile apps.
- **Card management:** card selection, activation and deactivation, limit management and card-related customer services in the app.
- **Internet banking:** web banking channel for NBP, CDNS and Bank of Punjab.
- **Transaction Gateway:** in-branch gateway used by NBP branches to process fund transfers, IBFT and bill payments.
- **Back-office:** maker-checker controls, customer management, transaction search and app management (banks, billers, banners, service availability).
- **Security:** OAuth2, JWT, Keycloak and encryption in line with SBP security guidelines.

Open Connect – Financial Transaction Switch

Sep 2020 – Present

Java, Spring Boot, ISO 8583, REST, SOAP, TCP, RabbitMQ

- Core switch through which every Open Digital transaction is routed to banks and external networks, covering financial and non-financial transactions.
- **Inbound processing:** incoming IBFT, ATM cash withdrawals and POS purchases from 1LINK, routed to the bank's core banking system with responses returned to 1LINK.
- Multi-protocol integration over REST, SOAP, TCP and ISO 8583, with RabbitMQ-based messaging.
- Complex business logic and client-specific transaction templates to support each bank's requirements.
- Load-tested at **2,000 transactions per second (TPS)** with room to scale further, built for high availability and regulatory compliance in mission-critical payment processing.
- Transaction reversals (including inbound 1LINK reversals), timeout handling and duplicate-transaction prevention (idempotency) implemented in both the switch and the Open Digital platform for all client banks.
- Progressed from switch configuration to owning code fixes and new feature development.

EthSwitch IPS – Instant Payments, Ethiopia (On-site)

Mar 2025 – Mar 2026

Ethiopia's Interoperable Payment System | Java, Spring Boot, ISO 20022, REST APIs, JSON

- Led on-site delivery of P2P and P2M instant payments for EthSwitch, delivered successfully.
- Built ISO 20022 PACS message handlers with XSD schema validation and correlation-ID tracing across transactions.
- Designed REST/JSON APIs that simplified integration and onboarding for participating banks.
- Adapted Paysys's Pakistan payment infrastructure into a customized IPS integration layer meeting Ethiopian regulatory and interoperability requirements.
- Worked directly with EthSwitch and the platform providers on requirements, integration and testing.

Ehsaas Program – Government of Pakistan

Jan 2022 – Apr 2023

- Built backend services for a national subsidy distribution platform supporting merchant onboarding and disbursements through an Android app.

Mobilink Microfinance Bank – Digital Banking Implementation

Oct 2020 – Oct 2022

- One of the first Open Digital implementations (alongside NBP), covering mobile and web banking, CRM, onboarding, KYC, biometric verification and card management.

AWARDS

- **Integrity Champion Award** – Paysys Labs

EDUCATION

BS Computer Science

2016 – 2019

PAF-Karachi Institute of Economics & Technology (PAF-KIET), Karachi

Diploma of Associate Engineering (DAE), Information Technology

2015 – 2018

Govt. Polytechnic College, Karachi

LANGUAGES

English (Professional), Urdu (Native)